perplexity

Server Startup Procedure (3 Commands)

On your Windows 24/7 server:

```
cd C:\hrbuddy\backend
venv\Scripts\activate
uvicorn main:app --host 0.0.0.0 --port 8000 --reload
```

What each does

1. `cd C:\hrbuddy\backend` — Navigate to backend folder
2. `venv\Scripts\activate` — Activate Python virtual environment
3. `uvicorn main:app --host 0.0.0.0 --port 8000 --reload` — Start server
   - `main:app` = `main.py` → FastAPI app instance
   - `--host 0.0.0.0` = Accept connections from anywhere (not just localhost)
   - `--port 8000` = Listen on port 8000
   - `--reload` = Auto-restart on code changes (dev only; remove for production)

What you see when successful

```
INFO:     Will watch for changes in these directories: ['C:\\hrbuddy\\backend']
INFO:     Uvicorn running on http://0.0.0.0:8000 (Press CTRL+C to quit)
INFO:     Started reloader process [xxxxx]
INFO:     Started server process [xxxxx]
INFO:     Waiting for application startup.
[INFO] Indexed 203 new chunks from C:\hrbuddy\documents
INFO:     Application startup complete.
```

Access the chatbot

`http://YOUR_SERVER_IP:8000`

Production startup (no auto-reload)

```
uvicorn main:app --host 0.0.0.0 --port 8000
```

Auto-start on Windows boot

1. Create `C:\hrbuddy\start.bat`:

```
@echo off
cd C:\hrbuddy\backend
call venv\Scripts\activate
uvicorn main:app --host 0.0.0.0 --port 8000
```

2. Press `Win + R` → `shell:startup` → put shortcut to `start.bat` there

Troubleshooting

Issue	Fix
"Address already in use"	Kill old process: `taskkill /f /im python.exe`
"No module named..."	`pip install -r requirements.txt`
"Ollama not ready"	Start Ollama first: `ollama serve`
Page not loading first time	Wait for "[INFO] Indexed X new chunks" line

Ready in 30 seconds. Share `http://YOUR_SERVER_IP:8000` with employees.[1]

⁂

1. main.py